

Daily Bible Note

Date: August 9, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 37:15-28

15 Again the word of the LORD came to me, saying,

16 "As for you, son of man, take a stick for yourself and write on it: 'For Judah and for the children of Israel, his companions.' Then take another stick and write on it, 'For Joseph, the stick of Ephraim, and for all the house of Israel, his companions.'

17 Then join them one to another for yourself into one stick, and they will become one in your hand.

18 "And when the children of your people speak to you, saying, 'Will you not show us what you mean by these?'—

19 say to them, 'Thus says the Lord GOD: "Surely I will take the stick of Joseph, which is in the hand of Ephraim, and the tribes of Israel, his companions; and I will join them with it, with the stick of Judah, and make them one stick, and they will be one in My hand."'

20 And the sticks on which you write will be in your hand before their eyes.

21 "Then say to them, 'Thus says the Lord GOD: "Surely I will take the children of Israel from among the nations, wherever they have gone, and will gather them from every side and bring them into their own land;

22 and I will make them one nation in the land, on the mountains of Israel; and one king shall be king over them all; they shall no longer be two nations, nor shall they ever be divided into two kingdoms again.

23 They shall not defile themselves anymore with their idols, nor with their detestable things, nor with any of their transgressions; but I will deliver them from all their dwelling places in which they have sinned, and will cleanse them. Then they shall be My people, and I will be their God.

24 "David My servant shall be king over them, and they shall all have one shepherd; they shall also walk in My judgments and observe My statutes, and do them.

25 Then they shall dwell in the land that I have given to Jacob My servant, where your fathers dwelt; and they shall dwell there, they, their children, and their children's children, forever; and My servant David shall be their prince forever.

26 Moreover I will make a covenant of peace with them, and it shall be an everlasting covenant with them; I will establish them and multiply them, and I will set My sanctuary in their midst forevermore.

27 My tabernacle also shall be with them; indeed I will be their God, and they shall be My people.

28 The nations also will know that I, the LORD, sanctify Israel, when My sanctuary is in their midst forevermore."'''

II. Key Summary

- God tells Ezekiel to take two sticks — one written "For Judah," one written "For Joseph, the stick of Ephraim" — and to join them so they become one stick in his hand (vv. 15-17).
 - When the people ask what the sign means, God explains: He will gather the children of Israel from every nation they have been scattered to, bring them back to their own land, and make them one nation on the mountains of Israel under one king, never again divided into two kingdoms (vv. 18-22).
 - God promises to cleanse them so they no longer defile themselves with idols, to set David His servant as their king and their one shepherd, to make an everlasting covenant of peace with them, and to place His sanctuary in their midst forever (vv. 23-28).
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III. Passage Analysis

The split came from human hands; the joining happens in God's hand

The human power, which led to and perpetuated the division, is in contrast with the "mine hand," where all shall be re-united under Divine rule. [1]

The two sticks in Ezekiel's hand don't move toward each other on their own — God is the one who says "they will be one in My hand." The passage puts the repair squarely on God: people did the dividing, He does the joining.

God cleanses people, then moves in with them

They shall have the tokens of God's special presence with them and his gracious residence among them. When they profaned his sanctuary he took it from them, but now that they are purified God will dwell with them again. [2]

The cleansing in verse 23 and the sanctuary "in their midst" in verses 26-28 belong together. God wants His people clean because He plans to stay — and He calls that staying an everlasting covenant.

IV. Reflection Question

Which relationship in your life do you think you can't fix on your own?

The two sticks in Ezekiel's hand didn't join themselves — God said, "they will be one in My hand."

References

[1] BibleHub.com, Ellicott's Commentary for English Readers (Ezekiel 37:19), <https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/ezekiel/37-19.htm>

[2] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry's Complete Commentary (Ezekiel 37), https://www.blueletterbible.org/Comm/mhc/Eze/Eze_037.cfm